Home Water Damage Evidence Procedure

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Home Water Damage Evidence Procedure

This synthetic internal procedure guides evidence gathering for a home water-damage claim. It does not determine cover and must be used with the policy version and endorsements active on the date of loss.

1. Establish the reported cause

Record where water was first observed, how it entered the property, whether water accumulated outside before entry, and whether a pipe, appliance, drain, or roof defect has been identified. Keep flood, sudden escape of water, and gradual seepage as separate possible causes until evidence supports one.

2. Request proportionate evidence

- Dated photographs or video showing affected rooms and visible water lines.
- A plumber or surveyor report describing the source, condition, and likely duration of the leak.
- Repair invoices and any records of earlier leaks, damp, or maintenance.
- Details of steps taken to stop the water and limit further damage.
- The policy schedule and the date the loss is said to have occurred.

Do not request information that is not relevant to the cause, extent, or reasonable mitigation of the reported loss.

3. Assess chronology carefully

Distinguish the date the damage was discovered from the date it probably began. A sudden escape may cause damage that is only noticed later. Equally, a recently discovered stain may have resulted from repeated leakage over time. Explain any material uncertainty and seek focused evidence before drawing a conclusion.

4. Escalation

Refer to a technical claims lead when evidence supports more than one plausible cause, when a flood endorsement may change the base wording, or when a proposed decision would rely on gradual seepage. Record the clause and endorsement considered and the reason for escalation.